

Lack of feelings

Some teens are left wondering what's going on when their friends start developing crushes. If they don't have a crush on someone, it can be hard to understand the intensity of a friend's crush. Romantic and sexual attraction may happen as teens get older or when they meet the right person, or they might never experience it. When or whether a teen feels this type of attraction has no bearing on the way that person cares about and loves other people.



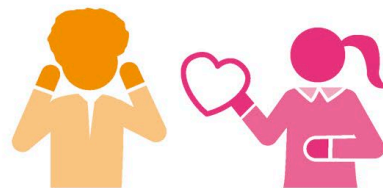
△ Other interests

If a person is not interested in romance or sex, that's okay, too.

TEEN HINTS

When someone has a crush on you

When you first realize that someone is attracted to you, it can bring a whole range of responses. Maybe you're excited because you feel the same way. You might be uncomfortable or unsure what to feel or say. Or you might feel awkward because you don't feel the same way. You might even worry that the friendship will change. Whatever your feelings are, they are completely valid. Just because someone likes you doesn't mean that you have to like them or act a certain way. Just be yourself and be honest about how you feel.



△ When someone acts inappropriately

If you've told someone you're not interested and they don't listen, that's not romantic and it's not acceptable behavior. A trusted adult can help you decide what to do.

△ Attraction and love

All sorts of reasons attract people to one another.

